

7.3 Excel 2003

Generate Random Numbers In Excel

Sometimes you may need to populate a sheet with random numbers. There's an easy function you can use to do this automatically. Type `=RAND()` in a cell to generate a number between 0 and 1. You can type `=RAND()*100` to generate a number between 1 and 100. After entering a function, you can use the fill handle to quickly populate as many cells as you'd like with random numbers. To use the fill handle, click the cell, move your pointer over the lower-right corner of the cell until it turns into a black plus sign, and drag it horizontally or vertically across the cells you wish to populate.

Results Without Formulas

In Excel 2002 and above, using the Smart Tags, it's very easy to copy and paste a result without the formula. First select the cell that contains the data you want to copy. Press `[Ctrl] + [C]` to copy the cell data, and then press `[Ctrl] + [V]` to paste the data in a new location. Click the arrow next to the 'Paste Options' smart tag, and then click 'Values Only'.

Use Your Spreadsheet Like A Database

You can use AutoFilter to analyse the data in your Excel spreadsheet based on specific criteria. For example, if you are a salesman with a spreadsheet listing all the clients you have in each region you cover, you can use AutoFilter to sort by a specific region and get a snapshot of just the clients in that region. Here's how you to use the feature: first click a cell in the list you want to filter. You should choose a cell that appears in a row that contains a heading and related data, such as a set of client names or phone numbers. Now on the 'Data' menu, point to 'Filter', and then click 'AutoFilter'. Arrows will appear at the heading of each column. Click an arrow, and choose your filter criteria from the drop-down menu. For example, you could filter for a number that's greater or less than a target figure. Now only rows containing data that meet the criteria will be displayed.